PHAROS
Pharmaceutical Alerts & Regulatory Observation System

# The PHAROS Handbook

*Every page, and how to run it*

*Prepared for*

*Dr Sama Mossad*

Administrator · full control of PHAROS

## Where the name PHAROS comes from

ALEXANDRIA, EGYPT

Φάρος

*Pharos, an island off Alexandria*

| | |
|---|---|
| **280 BC** | the lighthouse is built |
| **1,500+** | years it stood |
| **1 of 7** | ancient Wonders of the World |

Pharos was a small island off Alexandria. Around 280 BC a great lighthouse was built there. Its fire guided ships safely into the harbour for more than 1,500 years. Its name became the word for a lighthouse in many languages: *phare* in French, *faro* in Italian and Spanish.

Our PHAROS does the same job. A lighthouse does not steer the ship. **It keeps the light on, so we never sail on in the dark.**

The letters spell its full name: **Ph**armaceutical **A**lerts & **R**egulatory **O**bservation **S**ystem.

THE ENGINE · IT RUNS BY ITSELF, EVERY 4 HOURS, DAY AND NIGHT

1 **Read**
25 regulators, our mailbox and medical literature.

2 **Open**
Every new notice and its PDFs, in its own language.

3 **Keep**
The original goes into a locked archive.

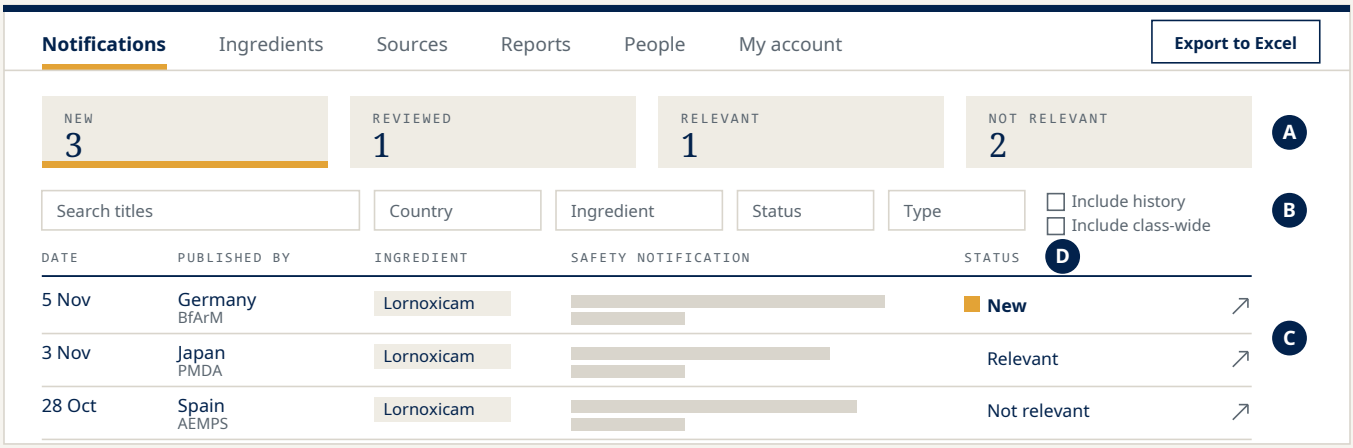
4 **Find**
Our ingredients, by every name, in every language.

5 **Show**
One row on Notifications, and a Telegram message.

# 01 Notifications: the home page

A DRAWING, NOT REAL DATA

*Every safety notice PHAROS found about our ingredients, one row each, newest first.*



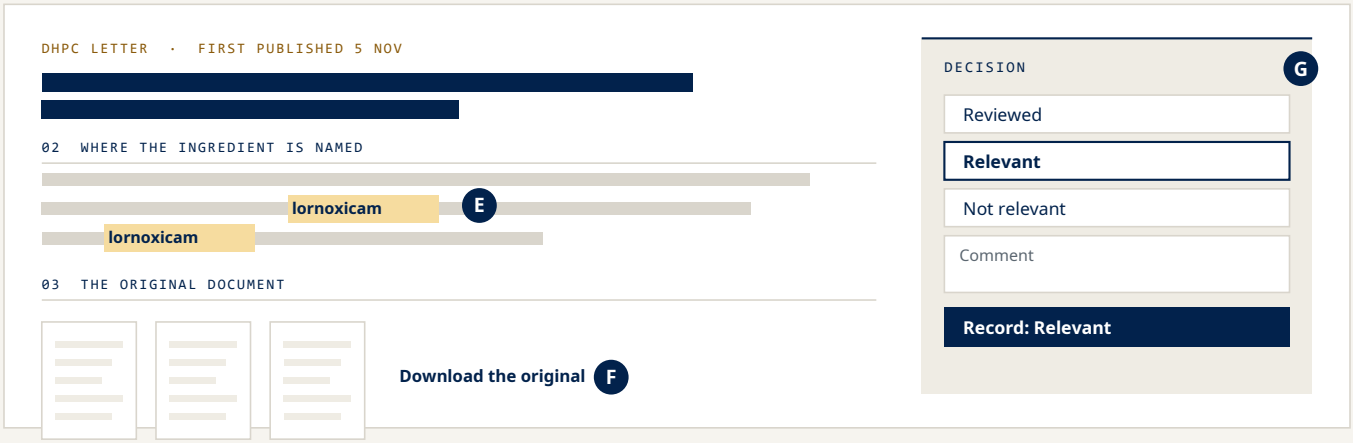

**A Counts**
Click a tile to see only those.

**B Filters**
Old news and drug-group news stay hidden until you tick them.

**C One row**
One safety news, even if ten countries published it.

**D Status**
New until someone decides.

CLICK A ROW: ONE NOTICE, OPENED




**E Highlighted words**
Exactly where our ingredient is named.

**F The original**
The real PDF, kept in the locked archive.

**G Decision**
Saved with your name and the time.

HOW TO REVIEW A NOTICE

1. Click the **New** tile, then open the first row.
2. Read the highlighted words. Is it really our ingredient?
3. Read the original PDF under it.
4. Choose **Reviewed**, **Relevant** or **Not relevant** and press **Record**. For Not relevant, a reason is required.
5. A decision is never edited. To change it, record a new one.

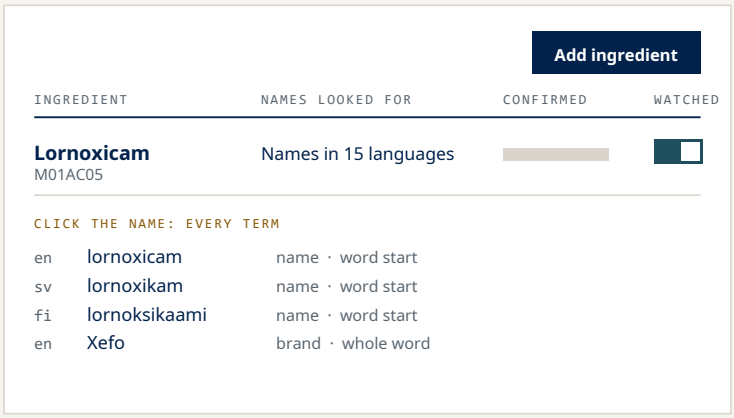
THE FOUR STATUSES

| New | → Reviewed | → Relevant | → Not relevant |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nobody has decided yet. | Read. Decision to come. | It concerns our products. | It does not. Say why. |

# 02 Ingredients: what PHAROS looks for

A DRAWING, NOT REAL DATA

*The watchlist. Each active ingredient, with every name it is searched under, in every language.*




HOW TO ADD AN ACTIVE INGREDIENT

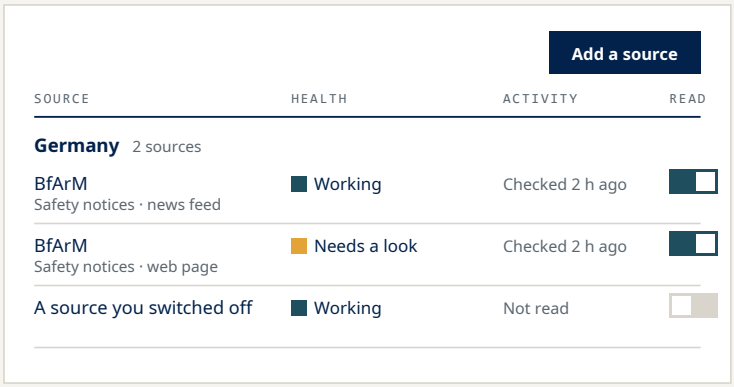
1. Press **Add ingredient**.
2. Type its name in any language or spelling.
3. Pick the right one from the list. Check the ATC code. Press **Confirm**.
4. Check the names PHAROS suggests for each language. Add or remove any. **Never when it is** keeps look-alike drugs out.
5. Press **Test against archive**, then **Save**. The watch starts on the next round.

WHAT YOU SEE ON THE TABLE

**Names looked for:** how many names, in how many languages. **Confirmed:** who checked it, and when. Press **Confirm** if nobody has. **Watched:** switch it off to pause an ingredient without losing it.

# 03 Sources: where PHAROS reads

*Every regulator's safety page, grouped by country, with a light that says if it is working.*




HOW TO ADD A SOURCE

1. Press **Add a source**.
2. Paste the link of the regulator's safety page or news feed.
3. Press **Test this link**. PHAROS reads it and shows the notices it found.
4. Choose the regulator, **What it publishes**, **How often to read it** and the languages.
5. Press **Save this source**. It can be saved only if the test found notices.

WHAT YOU SEE ON THE TABLE

**Health:** the light below. **Activity:** when it was last checked, and the date of its newest notice. **Last 48 hours:** runs, items seen, new, matched. **Read:** on or off.

THE HEALTH LIGHTS

■ Working ■ Needs a look ■ Not reachable ■ Blocks automated reading □ Not checked yet

Switch **Read** off to stop reading a source. If a source is not working, PHAROS has already messaged the administrators.

GOOD TO KNOW

### A new ingredient

PHAROS looks for it from the next round. Its product leaflets are watched within a day.

### A new source

Its first read is quiet: what it finds is saved, but no message goes out for old news.

### A site that blocks reading

PHAROS never forces its way in. Such regulators are read from their email newsletters instead.

## 04 Reports

*Our proof that we looked, month by month.*

**Monthly reports**
An Excel file and a PDF for every month, made by itself on the 1st at 05:00 for the month before. Download and file them.

**Screening log**
Pick a month. See every source: checks, failures, items read, new and matched.

**Tip**
On Notifications, **Export to Excel** saves the table as you filtered it.

## 05 People

*Who can sign in, what each person may do, and what messages they get.*

HOW TO INVITE A PERSON

1. Press **Invite a person**.
2. Write the full name and work email. Choose the role.
3. Press **Send the invitation**. They get an email to choose a password.

In the table: change a **Role**, switch **Can sign in** off to stop someone at once, and choose their **Messages**.

THE THREE ROLES

**Reader**
Sees everything.

**Reviewer**
Also records decisions and links or splits copies.

**Administrator**
Everything: ingredients, sources, people, Telegram. Dr Sama Mossad's role.

## My account

CONNECT TELEGRAM

1. Press **Connect Telegram**.
2. Open the link on your phone and press **Start**. It works for 24 hours.
3. Under **What I receive**, choose your messages.

TURN ON REAL TELEGRAM MESSAGES

1. Press **Send me a test message** and check your phone.
2. Read **What would have gone**: the messages kept while in test mode.
3. Tick the approval box, then press **Turn real messages on**. **Back to dry run** stops them again.

THE MESSAGES PHAROS SENDS

**Immediate message**
A new notice about one of our ingredients.

**Daily digest**
News that names only the drug group. About 10:00.

**Source health**
A source stopped working. Administrators.

**Monthly report**
The PDF on the 1st. Administrators.

REMEMBER

1. A decision is never edited. You add a new one after it.
2. Comments stay in PHAROS. They never go by Telegram.
3. Every time on screen is Cairo time.
4. PHAROS finds and shows. A person decides.

*Prepared by hand for Dr Sama Mossad and the pharmacovigilance team of Sato Pharma.*